

A Star Fleet Battles™ Rule Proposal

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Often found on

colony worlds that have been at least modestly-developed, these are secure, semi-hardened warehouses that store significant quantities of military supplies, distributing them to nearby installations and/or orbital facilities/ships. While nominally military infrastructure, they were frequently operated under private contracts and primarily utilized civilian staff, leavened by a few soldiers in key positions.

These bases were a curious hybrid of military and civilian aspects. Although equipped with shields and even phasers (notably, however, the Hydrans never armed their versions with Phaser-Gs), they could not provide seeking weapon guidance (FD3.0) or mine command-control capabilities (M5.0); this rule forms an exception to a number of other rules. The "boarding parties" were almost entirely civilian "security guards"; they could only defend the base, and could not be deployed offensively (not, for example, to participate in a "hit and run" attack); crew units cannot be converted into militia under (D15.83). This sort of base can become a GCL and participate in a Power Grid (R1.28P).

None of these bases would have T-bombs or transporter artillery, except as cargo. Because the mostly-civilian personnel would not be trained in deployment of those things, even if present in cargo, they would not be able to use those weapons in defense of the planet or the base. In theory, a full-fledged military unit could send a trained crew unit to the logistics base, and that crew could employ those weapons.

Unusually for Size Class 5 units, these bases do have a Life Support cost, which is an exception to (R1.14A3); it reflects the power needed for specialized cargo storage (for example, climate control, or even stasis). While it would not have been unusual to find at least one of these bases on a colony world, there would almost never be more than one *per* hex side of a planet, and they would typically be deployed in conjunction with one or more military bases on the same hex side. The largest of these bases would commonly be found on home worlds and core systems.

Sizes and Common Attributes: While details varied, the design and operation of this sort of base (which were usually, especially on colony worlds, assembled using pre-fabricated components after the site had been cleared and leveled) was sufficiently similar across the Alpha Octant empires that generic base SSDs are suitable to represent all of them in the game. There are three sizes of these bases: Small, Medium and Large. For game purposes, all are treated as Size Class 5 units. They all had a single 12-point shield and a Shield Cost of $\frac{1}{2} + \frac{1}{2}$. They also had Sensor, Scanner and Damage Control boxes as defined in (R1.14B). There were no refits.

The process to change the size of the base mainly involved adding (or subtracting) modules (that provided power, transporters, *etc*) and enclosing more land in the shell of the complex (represented as cargo). Due to the unusual nature of the construction (as compared to other ground bases), these bases are built *in situ*; they are not lowered from orbit as described in (R1.14A4) and cannot be raised from the surface. A Large base can participate in a Power Grid, which forms a technical exception to part of (R1.28P).

The

smallest of these bases had a Life Support cost of $\frac{1}{4}$ and a single Excess Damage box. The system boxes include: 1xBridge, 3xAPR, 1xBattery, 1xPh3/FH, 2xTransporter and 250xCargo. They would host a single administrative shuttle and four HTS. The staff would number about 10 crew units, including two boarding parties. 8 BPV.

Moving up a size, this base design had a Life Support cost of $\frac{1}{3}$ and two Excess Damage boxes. The system boxes include: 1xBridge, 1xAuxiliary Control, 5xAPR, 1xBattery, 1xPh3/FH, 4xTransporter, 1xTractor and 725xCargo. The shuttle bays were designed for two administrative shuttlecraft and six HTS. The staff would number about 18 crew units, including four boarding parties. 12 BPV.

The

largest of these bases would be a sprawling facility, with a Life Support cost of $\frac{3}{4}$ and three Excess Damage boxes. The system boxes include: 1xBridge, 1xAuxiliary Control, 1xEmergency Bridge, 10xAPR, 2xBattery, 2xPh3/FH, 8xTransporter, 2xTractor and 1300xCargo. It was designed to handle up to six administrative shuttlecraft and another dozen HTS. The staff would number about 40 crew units, including eight boarding parties. 30 BPV.

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